

DUMB CANE

Dieffenbachia

This plant has a lot going for it: the soothingly soft, fresh shades of its green foliage and its air-purifying qualities. Little wonder it continues to be one of the most popular houseplants to grow—just don't try to eat it!

“My luscious leaves will take toxins from the air.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

A warm room with indirect sunlight is ideal; this is especially important in spring and summer, since tender leaves will be scorched by direct light.



POTTING

Repot every year or two in spring into a slightly larger container. Use a fast-draining compost, adding gravel or pebbles to help water flow.



GROWTH RATE

Can grow up to 2½ft (80cm) tall and 2ft (60cm) wide and won't need any pruning apart from the removal of yellow leaves.



CARE

In summer, water to keep the soil moist (maybe even twice a week) and feed monthly. In winter, water sparingly and place in good light.



I'll remove toxins

I use my leaves to absorb xylene from the air—a sweet-smelling hydrocarbon used in paints, polishes, and solvents. By doing this, I'll help alleviate irritability and symptoms of depression caused by long-term exposure to the toxin.



Help me feel at home

I like humid environments, so place me on a wet pebble tray or use a humidifier to keep me happy. I'm also at my best with other plants. I thrive when displayed or potted alongside others, because when we're together, humidity levels are higher.